

Lifestyles: Nockers often find other people to be enigmas, with complex, fragile feelings that are easily offended by nocker sensibilities. This does not mean that they avoid people, but rather approach them as puzzles to be solved. However, they do prefer homes and workplaces where they can practice their craft in solitude. Machine shops, engineering, body shops, and programming are all ideal occupations for nockers.

Childling: Nockers in this stage are curious about the inner workings of everything. They would rather take things apart than put them together. The need to understand how things work can become an obsession and, left to their own devices, their tinkering may lead to trouble when they take apart the dukes chimerical, stream-powered vehicle. Understanding people is also a pastime for childlings — they pick and poke, trying to decipher what makes people tick.

Wilder: Nocker wilders are wildly creative innovators. They spend hours and days on end in the workshop honing their craftsmanship, to the exclusion of everything else, often even forgetting to eat. The latest tech, the newest design — these are the things that interest them. They are willing to take chances in order to come up with the newest and most fantastic design, often resulting in catastrophic (and sometimes humorous) failures. But sometimes they have incredible successes as well.

Grump: Absolute perfection of their skills are of the utmost important to nocker grumps. These nockers are often master craftspeople who have a great store of knowledge. Rather than seeking the newest and most innovative designs, they have a deep desire for perfection — which, much to their chagrin, they can never attain. This often leads to bouts of deep despair. They often take on apprentices and pass on their knowledge, while making the life of the poor apprentice miserable.

Revelry: Tinkering and mending things is what gives a nocker joy. To achieve Revelry, a nocker might spend some time in her shop repairing or creating a non-chimerical device that does not belong to her, or might work with other engineers or inventors to brainstorm a new device.

Unleashing: Cantrips cast by nockers often leave a traces of the byproducts of their craft: grease stains and the smell of burning sulfur or other unpleasant chemical smells are often common, as well as wisps of foul-smelling smoke. A rapping or knocking sound is often heard; the greater the power of the cantrip, the louder the sound.

Affinity: Prop

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Make It Work — Nockers are masters of whipping up items on demand with little more than random materials, some Glamour, and a highly cinematic and honestly self-serving appreciation of “science.” A nocker can improvise all manner of temporary, but useful, chimerical items from apparently improbable materials, such as creating a crude firearm with little more than a light bulb, a water pistol, and a handful of nails. Such items require an Intelligence + Crafts roll, with a variable difficulty, and cost between one and three points of Glamour depending on the materials available as well as the complexity of the item.

A nocker must have some degree of privacy when working on chimerical items. Kithain can be present, as long they do not disturb the nocker, but chimerical materials cannot be worked in the presence of mortals.

Fix-It — Nockers can fix just about anything, chimerical or mundane. Sometimes all it takes is a kick and a few harsh words to scare a machine into working again. To fix a device the nocker’s player must make a successful Intelligence + Crafts or Manipulation + Intimidation roll. The difficulty can range from 5 (for a simple problem in a simple device) to 9 (for a difficulty problem in a complex machine).

Frailty

Perfect is the Enemy of Done — Nockers strive for perfection in everything they make, and yet they can never succeed. No matter how many successes a nocker rolls when creating something, it always has a minor (but irreparable) flaw.

Whenever a nocker-made device is used in a stressful situation the Storyteller can ask the player to roll one die. If the die shows “1,” the device fails or breaks in a particularly spectacular fashion.

Stereotypes

Gretchen Steelworth, a nocker bike mechanic, grumbles:

On Boggans — They’re fast, so they’re either cheap or good, too. You don’t get all three.

On Clurichaun — Drunks and power tools don’t mix. Sorry, was that insensitive? Bite me.

On Eshu — They just don’t know when to shut up. They go on, and on, and on.... Sometimes they have something important to say, but you have to sift through the meandering drivel to find anything useful.

On Piskies — Unruly and reckless children. Don’t ever let one into your workshop or you’re likely to find your best tools glued together.

On Pooka — Useless furballs! They waste their lives playing tricks and pranks.

On Redcaps — Dangerous folk, but sometimes useful, especially if you want to dispose of some unwanted evidence...err...garbage. Just don’t piss them off.

On Satyrs — Let’s party all night and on into the day, never mind that world is slipping into Winter. Hedonistic freaks, the lot of ‘em.

On Selkies — Don’t fall in love with one. Ahem. Damn dusty in here.

On Arcadian Sidhe — They think they’re hot stuff, but they don’t understand this world and its workings as we do.

On Autumn Sidhe — They want to rule, and who are we to say no. They pay well and I’ll happily take their commissions.

On Sluagh — Buncha creepy a-holes, if you ask me. Skulking around, up to no good, I’m sure of it.

On Trolls — They are the strongest and toughest of us all, but their hearts can be surprisingly tender.